

Targeted Messages to Students

This lesson includes:

1. Identifying students that you can send a personalized message to
2. Reviewing some template messages
3. Writing personalized messages to three to five students
4. Reflection

Sending a personalized message to students in the class can be an effective way to encourage them to attend group study sessions and to make them feel cared for.

Identifying students that you can send a personalized message to

It can be helpful to look at a list of students while you think. I recommend that you open the canvas page and look at the list of students' names while you consider each of these questions. Hopefully at the end, you will have three to five students that you have chosen to receive a personalized message.

Are there any students that you have interacted with recently during class? When you make a connection with a student in class, that does not always lead to them attending study sessions, but a quick follow up message can make them feel seen and included.

What about students that have missed a class recently? Letting someone know that you noticed their absence can be a friendly way to show them that you care. If you cannot think of a name, your professor may be helpful with this. Ask your professor for the names of some students that have unexpectedly missed classes recently.

Can you identify students who attended study sessions in the past, but who have not returned in a while? Sometimes students get busy and start to prioritize other things. This is understandable, but a little personalized message may help them to make sure that they are giving the class their full attention.

Can you think of a student who made an interesting contribution during class? For example, is there a student who asked an interesting question or contributed to group work? When you let a student know that you notice their cool behavior in class, it can lead to a sparking a connection with them. People like to be noticed like that.

Can you think of a student that you have not connected with yet, but that you can picture in your head? If there is something positive and inoffensive about this person that you can respectfully comment on, that might be a good way to try to spark a

connection with them. For example, “I noticed you in class the other day and you were wearing a tee-shirt of my favorite band. My favorite song of theirs is X. How about you?” Or “We have not been able to connect in class, but I wanted to tell you that I notice the way you take notes with all the different colored pencils. That seems cool, and I would love to learn more about your system!”

Once you have identified a handful of students, move onto the next part.

Reviewing some template messages

Keep the message short and sweet, but always include the relevant information about your next group study session, including time/location/topic. Also, be sure to include their name in the initial greeting (e.g. “Hi Dimitrius!”). Here are some sample templates:

I really enjoyed our conversation this week about multiple regressions. I was thinking about what I explained to you, and I hope that it was clear. Please message me if you have any follow up questions. I also wanted to let you know that I will be covering this topic in the group study session on Wednesday @ 1-1:50 in the ASC. We will be practicing some problems, and I will be able to help you really master that content. I hope to see you then!

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I noticed that you weren't in class this week. I hope that everything is okay. I missed your funny comments during group work. I look forward to seeing you in class very soon. Please let me know if I can be any help.

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I was just thinking about the awesome job that you did in class when you were sharing the research that your group found about prisons. Really impressive! I hope to see you in my group study sessions this week. We will be planning our outlines for the in-class essay. I would love to have a chance to see what cool ideas you have about the topic!

Writing personalized messages to three to five students

Make sure that the message is written in your voice and reflects your personality. Try to include something in the message that only applies to this particular student. That is what makes it a personal message.

Also, be careful that you are not being overly intimate or crossing anyone's boundaries. You don't want to accidentally come off as a creep.

Once you have finished sending your messages move on to the reflection.

Reflection

Click this link and answer the following reflection prompt:

Copy and paste one of the messages that you sent. Tell us about the message and the student. Then reflect on how you can continue to use personalized messages to connect with students in the class.